

21/04/2025

Well, Refrain, Afterward, Certainly, Devious

1. Well (ठीक / अच्छा) (Adverb / Interjection / Adjective / Noun) (wel) (Neutral/Positive)

- **Meaning (English):** In a good, satisfactory, or thorough manner; also used to express surprise or transition.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** अच्छी तरह से; एक विस्मय या संक्रमण के रूप में भी उपयोग होता है।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *wel* → **Proto-Germanic *wel*** → Proto-Indo-European *wel-* (to wish, choose, love)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** properly, thoroughly, fine
 - **Antonyms:** poorly, badly
- **Connotation:** Neutral/Positive (depends on context)
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student smiling after completing an exam confidently, saying "Well, that went better than expected."



- **Use in Non-Fiction:**

The word well is frequently used in non-fiction to indicate clarity, transition, or emphasis in discussions or analytical writing. For instance, in academic essays or opinion pieces, a writer might say, "Well, the evidence clearly contradicts the earlier claim," to shift into a rebuttal. In instructional or self-help content, it appears to introduce a clarification: "Well, it's important to note that habits take time to develop." The versatility of well allows it to maintain a conversational tone while grounding the reader in the author's reasoning, making it both approachable and effective in guiding the flow of thought.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  "She did the task well." (उसने काम अच्छी तरह से किया।)
-  "She did the task good." (Incorrect grammar)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- Well, we should probably start the meeting now. (ठीक है, हमें अब शायद मीटिंग शुरू कर देनी चाहिए।)
- **Grammar:**
 - "Well" functions as a discourse marker or transition.
 - Sentence type: Declarative
 - Structure: Interjection + Subject + Modal + Verb + Object + Time Phrase

- **Common Collocations:** Well done, well known, speak well, well established

- **My Statement:**

- **(ADVERB)**
 - She did well in her exams.
 - You have to behave well in the meeting like a professional. ***
 - You need to behave well in the meeting, like a professional.
 - There is one request, just behave well with our staff. ***
 - Just one request—treat our staff well.
- **(INTERJECTION)**
 - Well, you got the point on time. ***
 - Well, it looks like you got the point on time.
 - Well, what do you think about this project?

- Well, how can we trust you again ? ***
- Well, how can we trust you again?
- **(ADJECTIVE)**
 - Everything should be well in life after suffering for so long.
 - Is everything well in your life?
 - We cannot say that he is well at all.
- **(NOUN)**
 - Saudi aramco found a well of fortune in the barren desert.
 - Is there any well here where I can extract some water?
 - There were several traders who became rich by selling shovels for digging wells in search of oil.

- **My Notes:**

- She did well in her exams.
 - "Did" is the main verb.
 - "Well" is an adverb modifying how she did in her exams.
- The word "well" as a noun typically refers to a deep hole dug to access water, oil, or resources, or metaphorically as in "a well of knowledge/emotion."

2. Refrain (परहेज़ करना / रोकना) (Verb / Noun) (ri-frayn) (Formal/Restrained)

- **Meaning (English):** To stop oneself from doing something; also a repeated line or phrase in poetry/music.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** स्वयं को कुछ करने से रोकना; किसी कविता या गीत की दोहराई गई पंक्ति।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old French *refraindre* → Latin *refrēnare* (to bridle back, restrain)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** abstain, hold back, restrain
 - **Antonyms:** indulge, allow
- **Connotation:** Formal, often associated with discipline or self-control
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person at a buffet controlling themselves from overeating.



- **Use in Non-Fiction:**

The word refrain is often employed in non-fiction writing to emphasize the importance of self-control, policy adherence, or behavioral guidance. In health articles, authors may urge readers to “refrain from consuming processed sugar” to promote wellness. Legal and ethical texts frequently instruct professionals to “refrain from disclosing confidential information.” In management or leadership content, refrain is used to guide conflict

resolution: "Leaders should refrain from reacting impulsively during disputes." The term carries a formal, instructive tone, making it suitable for contexts where restraint is essential and recommended behavior must be communicated clearly and respectfully.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  "Please refrain from using mobile phones here." (कृपया यहाँ मोबाइल का उपयोग करने से परहेज़ करें।)
-  "Please refrain to use mobile." (Incorrect preposition)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- She refrained from commenting. (उसने टिप्पणी करने से परहेज़ किया।)
- **Grammar:**
 - "Refrained" is the main verb in simple past.
 - Structure: Subject + Verb + Preposition + Gerund

- **Common Collocations:** Refrain from action, refrain from commenting, refrain from speech

- **My Statement:**

- **(VERB)**
 - I refrain from using social media for more than 20 minutes in a day.
 - We should refrain from eating junk foods and switch to nutritious meals. ***
 - We should refrain from eating junk food and switch to nutritious meals.
 - She has been refrained from taking the exam due to improper documentation. ***
 - She had to refrain from taking the exam due to improper documentation.
- **(NOUN)**
 - The refrain of the poem was written by the famous poet.
 - The refrain was crafted well and ensured rhythmic nature. ***
 - The refrain was crafted well and added to the poem's rhythmic quality.
 - Only a few were able to comprehend the refrain. ***
 - Only a few were able to comprehend the refrain.

- **My Notes:**

- **Incorrect:** She has been refrained from taking the exam due to improper documentation.
 - The verb "refrain" is intransitive, meaning it does not take a direct object.
 - **Passive voice (has/have been + past participle)** requires a transitive verb, which "refrain" is not.
 - You cannot say "has been refrained" because **nobody can "refrain" someone else**. One can only refrain oneself.

3. Afterward (बाद में) (Adverb) (af-ter-werd) (Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** At a later time; subsequently.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी कार्य के बाद का समय, बाद में।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *afterwardes* → Old English *æfterweard* (toward after)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** later, subsequently, thereafter
 - **Antonyms:** before, earlier
- **Connotation:** Neutral, time-related
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A group enjoying dessert afterward following a meal.



- **Use in Non-Fiction:**

Afterward is commonly used in non-fiction to establish a clear sequence of events or to transition smoothly from one point to another. In historical writing, one might read, "The treaty was signed in 1945; afterward, global alliances began to shift." In scientific or instructional texts, it helps maintain chronological clarity: "Complete the experiment step-by-step; afterward, record your observations." In self-help or motivational writing, it's used to reflect on outcomes: "He struggled initially but succeeded afterward due to

consistent effort.” Its neutral, time-based connotation makes it effective for structuring information logically, emphasizing cause and effect, or outlining steps in a process.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  “We went to dinner and saw a movie afterward.” (हमने डिनर किया और बाद में फिल्म देखी।)
-  “We went to dinner and saw a movie afterwords.” (Incorrect spelling)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- She apologized afterward. (उसने बाद में माफी मांगी।)
- **Grammar:**
 - “Afterward” is an adverb modifying the verb “apologized.”
 - Structure: Subject + Verb + Adverb

- **Common Collocations:** Soon afterward, right afterward, immediately afterward

- **My Statement:**

- He completed the work afterward.
- We managed to watch the movie afterward.
- You won’t be able to do this afterward.

- **My Notes:**

- “Afterward” is an **adverb of time**, properly placed at the end to indicate something happened later.
- **Tone & Style Tip:**
 - If you’re writing more formally, “afterwards” with an -s is used more in British English, while “afterward” (without -s) is standard in American English.

4. Certainly (निश्चित रूप से) (Adverb) (sur-tuhn-lee) (Positive/Formal)

- **Meaning (English):** Without doubt; definitely.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** निश्चित रूप से; अवश्य।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old French *certeine* → **Latin *certus* (sure)** + **English adverbial suffix *-ly***
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** definitely, undoubtedly, surely
 - **Antonyms:** uncertainly, possibly, maybe
- **Connotation:** Confident, affirming
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A confident speaker affirming a point in a seminar with the word “Certainly.”



- **Use in Non-Fiction:**

Certainly is often used in non-fiction writing to convey confidence, affirmation, or assuredness in a claim or perspective. For instance, in academic or persuasive texts, it may appear in lines such as, “The data certainly suggests a strong correlation between the two variables.” In journalism or biographical writing, it strengthens a factual stance: “She certainly made an impact on the company’s future.” The word adds a tone of

conviction, making statements more persuasive without being overly aggressive. Its polite yet firm nature also helps maintain professionalism while asserting a conclusion, making it a useful tool in analytical or explanatory writing.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  “He will certainly attend the meeting.” (वह निश्चित रूप से बैठक में भाग लेगा।)
-  “He certainly will to attend.” (Unnecessary ‘to’)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- You can certainly trust her judgment. (आप निश्चित रूप से उसकी निर्णय क्षमता पर भरोसा कर सकते हैं।)
- **Grammar:**
 - “Certainly” modifies the verb “trust” as an adverb of affirmation.
 - Structure: Subject + Modal + Adverb + Verb + Object

- **Common Collocations:** Certainly true, certainly believe, certainly helpful

- **My Statement:**

- He will certainly accept the offer afterward.
- This solution certainly works well without any problem. ***
- This solution certainly works well without problems.
- The paper is certainly copied from various sources without providing citations. ***
- The paper has certainly been copied from various sources without proper citation.

- **My Notes:**

5. Devious (कपटी / घुमावदार) (Adjective) (dee-vee-uhs) (Negative/Formal)

- **Meaning (English):** Showing a skillful use of underhanded tactics to achieve goals; also can mean indirect or winding.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** कपटी, चालाकी से लक्ष्य प्राप्त करने वाला; घुमावदार रास्ता।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *deviare* (to turn aside) → **de-** (off) + **via** (way)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** deceitful, sly, cunning
 - **Antonyms:** honest, straightforward
- **Connotation:** Negative when referring to behavior; neutral when describing paths
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A chess player smiling deviously after setting up a hidden trap.



- **Use in Non-Fiction:**

Devious is often employed in non-fiction writing—especially in investigative journalism, psychological analysis, or political commentary—to describe actions or individuals that are dishonest, manipulative, or indirect in intent. For example, “The company employed devious tactics to avoid regulations,” highlights unethical behavior while maintaining a formal tone. In biographies or historical accounts, it may describe strategic yet morally

questionable decisions: “His devious route to power unsettled even his allies.” The word carries a negative connotation, often linked to cunning deception, making it powerful when highlighting ethical concerns, character flaws, or systemic issues that require critical attention or reform.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  “His devious plan was exposed.” (उसकी कपटी योजना का खुलासा हुआ।)
-  “He is very deviously.” (Wrong form – adverb used instead of adjective)

- **Example + Explanation:**

- She used devious methods to gain control. (उसने नियंत्रण प्राप्त करने के लिए कपटी तरीकों का इस्तेमाल किया।)
- **Grammar:**
 - “Devious” is an adjective modifying “methods.”
 - Structure: Subject + Verb + Adjective + Object + Infinitive Phrase

- **Common Collocations:** Devious route, devious plan, devious tactics

- **My Statement:**

- The company was within the purview of the tax department for executing their devious methods to commit tax fraud.
- The game of chess is won by implementing devious strategies in real time.
- Your devious plan won't success in the global market ***
- Your devious plan won't succeed in the global market.

- **My Notes:**